- A correlation path can include more than one transition—for example, starting with a time series representing a metric to related spans to logs lines or profiles of a particular service.
- The metadata necessary to drive correlation can either be standardized after the fact (e.g., Prometheus relabeling) or up front (e.g., OpenTelemetry's semantic conventions).
- Not all correlation paths are equal. Some, like metrics–traces or traces–logs are widely used and supported, while others are not.
- Exemplars (in OpenMetrics and OpenTelemetry) allow you to do metrics–traces correlation by embedding a pointer to a trace in a metric.
- We're still in the early days of signal correlation; be aware of the limitations and set expectations accordingly.
- There are several challenges associated with implementing correlation, especially concerning UX and signals volume, cardinality, and sampling.
- Using OpenTelemetry is likely the most efficient and effective way to hedge against challenges in the correlation space.